

Power of Interest
Code of Conduct for Volunteers and Staff

Version: V0.2

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The purpose of the Code of Conduct for Volunteers and Staff is to set out standards of behaviour expected from volunteers and staff of Power of Interest (POI). All volunteers and staff should ensure that they have read and comply with this Code of Conduct.

Volunteers and staff should maintain the highest standards of behaviour in the performance of their duties by:

- Fulfilling their role as outlined in their written **volunteer role description** or **staff role description** to a satisfactory standard;
- Performing their volunteer role or staff role to the best of their ability in a safe, efficient and competent way;
- Following the charity's policies and procedures as well as any instructions or directions reasonably given to them;
- Acting honestly, responsibly and with integrity;
- Treating others with fairness, equality, dignity and respect;

- Raising concerns about possible wrongdoing witnessed by the volunteer or staff in the course of the volunteer's or staff's role with POI with the Safeguarding Director;
- Meeting time and task commitments and providing sufficient notice when they will not be available so that alternative arrangements can be made;
- Acting in a way that is in line with the purpose and values of the charity and that enhances the work of the charity;
- Communicating respectfully and honestly at all times;
- Observing safety procedures, including any obligations concerning the safety, health and welfare of other people in line with training provided to volunteers;
- Reporting any health and safety concerns;
- Directing any questions regarding POI's policies, procedures, support or supervision to the volunteer's supervisor;
- Addressing any issues or difficulties about any aspect of their role or how they are managed in line with POI's grievance procedures;
- Declaring any interests that may conflict with their role or the work of the charity (e.g. business interests or employment). If any doubt arises as to what constitutes a conflict of interest, volunteers or staff may seek guidance from the Directors;
- Keeping confidential matters confidential;
- Using POI communication platforms, including Slack, professionally and only for legitimate organisational purposes. Personal messaging apps, private social media messaging and personal email accounts should not be used to communicate with children or young people participating in POI activities;

- Handle personal information in accordance with the charity's Data Protection Policy and applicable data protection legislation;
 - Exercising caution and care with any documents, material or devices, containing confidential information and at the end of their involvement with POI returning any such documents, material in their possession;
 - Seeking authorisation before communicating externally on behalf of POI;
 - Dress appropriately for the activities being undertaken, taking account of safety, professionalism and inclusivity;
 - Staff and volunteers must inform the Chair or Safeguarding Lead of any criminal investigation, charge or conviction that may affect their suitability for their role.
- Disclosure requirements will be handled in accordance with UK law and the charity's Safer Recruitment Policy.

Volunteers are expected NOT to:

- Staff and volunteers must use social media, email Slack and other internet sites responsibly and must not represent personal opinions as those of the charity unless authorised to do so.
- Seek or accept gifts, hospitality or other benefits that could influence, or reasonably be perceived to influence, their judgement or create a conflict of interest;
- Engage in any activity that may cause physical or mental harm or distress to another person (such as verbal abuse, physical abuse, assault, bullying, or discrimination or harassment on the grounds of gender, civil status, family status, sexual orientation, religion, age, disability, race or membership of the Traveller community);

- Be affected by alcohol, drugs, or medication which will affect their abilities to carry out their duties and responsibilities while volunteering;
- Provide a false or misleading statement, declaration, document, record or claim in respect of POI, its volunteers, employees or company directors;
- Engage in any activity that may damage property;
- Take unauthorised possession of property that does not belong to them.
- Engage in illegal activity while carrying out their role.
- Improperly disclose, during or after their involvement with charity name ends, confidential information gained in the course of their role with charity name. This obligation continues after a person leaves the charity.

Breaches of this Code or of any POI's other policies and procedures by employees may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the charity's Disciplinary Policy.

The charity reserves the right to end a volunteer arrangement at any time where it considers this to be in the best interests of the charity, its beneficiaries or volunteers.

Volunteers acknowledge that no employment relationship is created in the context of their role with POI.

Staff and volunteers are expected to:

- act professionally and courteously;
- work collaboratively;
- respect confidentiality;

- respect diversity;
- challenge inappropriate behaviour constructively;
- support an inclusive environment where everyone feels welcome;
- read the policies of POI
- act in the best interests of the charity.

The board of company directors and members will review the Code of Conduct for Volunteers at 3-year intervals or as appropriate. The Directors are responsible for ensuring that this policy is implemented effectively. All other staff and volunteers, including company directors, are expected to facilitate this process.